

Swanzey by the Numbers

15 years of budgets & votes — a plain-language summary for residents · June 2026

What the record shows

- **We fund the town, but we can't borrow.** Budgets pass every year; big building projects need a 3/5 supermajority and keep falling just short (public works facility, 2024 and 2026).
- **Costs are climbing ~6–7% a year.** Wages, health insurance, and the ambulance contract — not new programs — drive most of it.
- **Voting 'no' on the budget no longer saves money.** The fallback 'default' budget is now within \$47,000 of the proposal.
- **The 2024 rate drop was a revaluation, not a tax cut.** Values went up, so the rate went down — your bill didn't fall by the same amount.
- **We're reshaping our government.** Voters grew the Select Board from 3 to 5, kept SB2, and took on the West Swanzey water system.

The numbers

Measure	2011 → 2025
Operating budget	\$5.75M → \$8.94M (+55%)
Budget voter support	81% → 57%
Default-budget 'savings'	~\$560K (2022) → \$47K (2025)
Total tax rate	\$24.51 (2021) → \$20.18 (2025)*

The path forward: save up for big projects instead of borrowing (so we stop losing 3/5 votes), chase the state and federal money already on the table, and keep our town administration stable.

*2024 was a revaluation year. Sources: Town of Swanzey Annual Reports 2011–2025; NH DRA; local news. Some figures are planning estimates.